

UMAR YUNUSA

Senior Backend Engineer • Node.js / TypeScript / PHP (Laravel) • AI-Augmented Development

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with 7 years building high-performance, secure systems across fintech, e-commerce, and enterprise platforms. Deep expertise in Node.js/TypeScript and PHP (Laravel/Codelgniter), with a proven track record executing PHP → Node.js migrations and designing modular, event-driven microservices architectures. Active open-source contributor to urllib3, Wagtail, and other projects; builder of publicly shipped tools including an AI-powered desktop file manager, a TypeScript code generation CLI, and a multilingual AI chatbot for African languages. Active practitioner of AI-augmented development—integrating Claude Code, OpenAI, Google Gemini, and Cohere APIs into daily workflows including RAG pipelines and LLM-powered document parsing. Experienced leading distributed remote teams across South Korea, Canada, and Nigeria in async environments aligned with EU/NA timezones.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Primary Stack: Node.js, TypeScript, NestJS, Express.js — RESTful APIs, WebSockets, Microservices, Event-driven, Serverless

Legacy / Migration: PHP, Laravel, Codelgniter — full codebase audit, refactor, and migration to Node.js/TypeScript

AI / LLM: Claude Code, OpenAI API, Google Gemini, Cohere — RAG systems, Pinecone, ChromaDB, LLM-assisted refactoring & docs

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB, Elasticsearch — query optimization, indexing, ORMs

Infrastructure: Docker, GitHub Actions, AWS, Azure, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Vercel

Testing & Security: PHPUnit, Pytest, Jest — Unit, Integration, E2E; OWASP, OAuth2, JWT; 85%+ coverage standards

Other Backend: Python (FastAPI, Flask), RabbitMQ, Celery, multi-tenant architecture, background job processing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Backend Engineer

MUST Company • South Korea (Remote) • Mar 2024 – Present

- Architected and led Node.js/TypeScript microservices-based fintech platform handling large daily transaction volumes; designed event-driven architecture with RabbitMQ for async processing.
- Planned and executed migration of legacy PHP (Laravel) services to modular Node.js/TypeScript — establishing migration patterns, documentation standards, and reusable service templates.
- Optimized complex PostgreSQL queries and indexing strategies, reducing response time from 3s → 150ms and improving query performance by 85%.
- Integrated AI/LLM tooling (Claude Code, Gemini) into development workflow for accelerated refactoring, automated code documentation, and test generation.
- Enforced OWASP security best practices and CI/CD pipelines via GitHub Actions across all backend services.
- Mentored 5 backend engineers on microservices design patterns and architectural best practices; contributed to 40% revenue growth through improved system reliability.

Backend Developer — AI & Data Science Team

Manaknight Digital • Ontario, Canada (Remote) • Jan 2023 – Apr 2024

- Built RESTful APIs using Python (FastAPI) and Node.js serving large daily request volumes; implemented background job processing with Celery and Redis.
- Engineered production AI pipelines integrating OpenAI, Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini, and Cohere APIs; built RAG systems with Pinecone and ChromaDB for LLM-powered fintech document parsing.
- Designed multi-tenant architecture supporting multiple clients on a single codebase; achieved average API latency <100ms.
- Maintained 85%+ code coverage through unit, integration, and E2E testing (Pytest, Jest); enforced CI/CD standards via GitHub Actions.
- Collaborated asynchronously with distributed teams across EU/NA timezones in an Agile/Scrum environment.

Technical Lead

Edawhtechnologies • Oyo State, Nigeria • Oct 2019 – Dec 2022

- Architected PHP (Laravel) media platform backend supporting large concurrent user volumes and Nigeria's national COVID travel portal processing large daily submissions.
- Led full-stack PHP/Laravel development from architecture through deployment; built scalable RESTful APIs, authentication systems (OAuth2, JWT), and data pipelines.
- Delivered MVPs for client startups from concept to production in 3–6 months; established code review processes reducing bugs by 40%.
- Mentored junior developers on Laravel best practices, design patterns, and backend security (OWASP).

Web Developer

GEM Center for Human Capital Development • Oyo State, Nigeria • Pre-2019

- Developed RESTful APIs and authentication/authorization systems using PHP (Laravel) for internal management platforms.
- Implemented bulk data export/import pipelines and role-based access control (RBAC) systems.

OPEN SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

urllib3: Contributed to the widely-used Python HTTP client library (100M+ weekly downloads) — one of the most depended-upon packages in the Python ecosystem.

Wagtail: Contributed to the leading open-source Django CMS powering thousands of production websites globally.

Other OSS: Active contributor to several additional open-source projects spanning backend utilities, developer tooling, and API integrations.

OPEN SOURCE PROJECTS BUILT

Omni File: AI-powered desktop file manager for Mac & Windows. 100% local/private — smart folder organization, offline audio/video transcription & subtitles, deep content search, file compression/conversion.

<https://fyunusa.github.io/omni-file/>

osbts (npm): TypeScript backend code generation CLI. Scaffolds DTOs, Entities, Controllers, Services, and Enums with Swagger decorator and TypeORM integration. Published on npm.

<https://www.npmjs.com/package/osbts>

Wazobia AI Agent: Multilingual AI chatbot for African native languages (Yoruba, Hausa, Igbo) — bridging the language gap in AI accessibility for West African users.

<https://wazobia-agent.netlify.app/>

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Science — University of Ibadan, Oyo State, Nigeria • Graduated Dec 2020

ADDITIONAL

Open Source & DPG: Contributor to urllib3, Wagtail, and other projects; builder of publicly shipped OSS tools. Aligned with Digital Public Goods ethos: modular, documented, accessible.

Remote Collaboration: 7 years in fully remote, async-first teams across South Korea, Canada, and Nigeria — proficient in EU/NA timezone overlap collaboration.

Mentorship: Mentored 15+ engineers across multiple organizations on backend architecture, security, and code quality.

Languages: English (Fluent), Hausa (Native)